National Transportation Safety Board
Aviation Accident Final Report

Location:	Truckee, CA	**Accident Number:**	SEA08CA053
Date & Time:	12/23/2007, 0945 PST	**Registration:**	N9086Y
Aircraft:	Piper PA-18-150	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Defining Event:		**Injuries:**	1 None
Flight Conducted Under:	Part 91: General Aviation - Personal		

Analysis

The pilot said that his engine started running rough while flying over mountainous terrain. There was a large snow covered meadow beneath him, so he circled it while trying to resolve his engine problem. His attempts to regain full power were unsuccessful. The airplane was equipped with large tundra tires, and the pilot believed that a precautionary landing under partial power was more prudent than proceeding to the nearest airport while crossing mountain ridges and over flying the surrounding forest. During a wheel landing in the snow, the airplane nosed over and came to rest inverted. The forward section of the airframe, both wings spars, and the vertical stabilizer were bent. The reason for the partial power loss was undetermined.

Probable Cause and Findings

The National Transportation Safety Board determines the probable cause(s) of this accident to be: The loss of partial engine power during cruise for undetermined reasons. A contributing factor was the snow covered terrain.

Findings

Occurrence #1: LOSS OF ENGINE POWER(PARTIAL) - NONMECHANICAL
Phase of Operation: CRUISE - NORMAL

Findings
1. (C) REASON FOR OCCURRENCE UNDETERMINED

Occurrence #2: FORCED LANDING
Phase of Operation: DESCENT - EMERGENCY

Occurrence #3: ON GROUND/WATER ENCOUNTER WITH TERRAIN/WATER
Phase of Operation: LANDING - FLARE/TOUCHDOWN

Findings
2. (F) TERRAIN CONDITION - SNOW COVERED
3. PRECAUTIONARY LANDING - PERFORMED - PILOT IN COMMAND

Occurrence #4: NOSE OVER
Phase of Operation: LANDING - ROLL

Factual Information

Pilot Information

Certificate:	Airline Transport	**Age:**	51, Male
Airplane Rating(s):	Multi-engine Land; Single-engine Land; Single-engine Sea	**Seat Occupied:**	Left
Other Aircraft Rating(s):	Airship	**Restraint Used:**	Seatbelt, Shoulder harness
Instrument Rating(s):	Airplane	**Second Pilot Present:**	No
Instructor Rating(s):	None	**Toxicology Performed:**	No
Medical Certification:	Class 2 With Waivers/Limitations	**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	06/01/2006
Occupational Pilot:		**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	
Flight Time:	7685 hours (Total, all aircraft), 143 hours (Total, this make and model), 30 hours (Last 90 days, all aircraft), 5 hours (Last 30 days, all aircraft), 1 hours (Last 24 hours, all aircraft)		

Aircraft and Owner/Operator Information

Aircraft Make:	Piper	**Registration:**	N9086Y
Model/Series:	PA-18-150	**Aircraft Category:**	Airplane
Year of Manufacture:		**Amateur Built:**	No
Airworthiness Certificate:	Normal	**Serial Number:**	18-8914
Landing Gear Type:	Tailwheel	**Seats:**	
Date/Type of Last Inspection:	Annual	**Certified Max Gross Wt.:**	
Time Since Last Inspection:		**Engines:**	1 Reciprocating
Airframe Total Time:		**Engine Manufacturer:**	Lycoming
ELT:	Installed, activated, did not aid in locating accident	**Engine Model/Series:**	O-360-A4M
Registered Owner:	Tristano Caracciolo	**Rated Power:**	180 hp
Operator:	Tristano Caracciolo	**Operating Certificate(s) Held:**	None

Meteorological Information and Flight Plan

Conditions at Accident Site:	Visual Conditions	**Condition of Light:**	Day
Observation Facility, Elevation:	TRK, 5050 ft msl	**Distance from Accident Site:**	12 Nautical Miles
Observation Time:	0954 PST	**Direction from Accident Site:**	170°
Lowest Cloud Condition:	Clear	**Visibility**	10 Miles
Lowest Ceiling:	None	**Visibility (RVR):**	
Wind Speed/Gusts:	Calm /	**Turbulence Type Forecast/Actual:**	/
Wind Direction:		**Turbulence Severity Forecast/Actual:**	/
Altimeter Setting:	30.51 inches Hg	**Temperature/Dew Point:**	-2°C / -4°C
Precipitation and Obscuration:	No Obscuration; No Precipitation		
Departure Point:	Truckee, CA (TRK)	**Type of Flight Plan Filed:**	None
Destination:	Reno, NV (4SD)	**Type of Clearance:**	None
Departure Time:	0930 PST	**Type of Airspace:**	

Wreckage and Impact Information

Crew Injuries:	1 None	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Passenger Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Fire:**	None
Ground Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Explosion:**	None
Total Injuries:	1 None	**Latitude, Longitude:**	39.472778, -120.332500

Administrative Information

Investigator In Charge (IIC):	James F Struhsaker	**Report Date:**	02/28/2008
Additional Participating Persons:	Mark Hinzman; FAA FSDO; Reno, NV		
Publish Date:			
Note:	This accident report documents the factual circumstances of this accident as described to the NTSB.		
Investigation Docket:	NTSB accident and incident dockets serve as permanent archival information for the NTSB's investigations. Dockets released prior to June 1, 2009 are publicly available from the NTSB's Record Management Division at pubinq@ntsb.gov, or at 800-877-6799. Dockets released after this date are available at http://dms.ntsb.gov/pubdms/.		

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The Independent Safety Board Act, as codified at 49 U.S.C. Section 1154(b), precludes the admission into evidence or use of any part of an NTSB report related to an incident or accident in a civil action for damages resulting from a matter mentioned in the report. A factual report that may be admissible under 49 U.S.C. § 1154(b) is available here.